

Prevalence Rates of Non-Communicable Diseases by Employment Status

Table 6.3.12 presents the prevalence rates of non-communicable diseases for the employed population aged 15 and over, based on their employment status at the time of the census.

Table 6.3.12 : Prevalence Rates of NCDs by Employment Status, 2024

Employment status	Employed Population	Diabetes	High Cholesterol	High Blood Pressure	Heart Disease	Kidney Disease	Thalassemia	Cancer	Stroke	Asthma	Epilepsy
Employed population aged 15 and over	7,670,749	7.8	7.1	7.9	2.1	0.6	0.1	0.2	0.2	1.5	0.2
Government paid employee	1,162,693	6.1	5.5	5.3	1.1	0.3	0.0	0.2	0.1	0.7	0.1
Semi government paid employee	170,713	7.6	6.9	6.5	1.5	0.3	0.0	0.2	0.1	0.9	0.1
Paid employee (private sector)	3,244,290	5.8	5.2	5.8	1.6	0.4	0.1	0.2	0.1	1.5	0.3
Employer (have employees)	277,868	13.8	11.0	10.5	2.8	0.5	0.0	0.2	0.2	0.9	0.1
Own account worker (don't have employees)	2,407,614	10.4	9.6	11.0	3.2	1.1	0.1	0.3	0.3	2.0	0.3
Contributing to family enterprise (unpaid family worker)	407,571	9.6	10.7	13.4	2.8	1.1	0.1	0.4	0.2	2.5	0.3

*Excluding the roofless population

The prevalence of diseases among paid employees in both the public and private sectors remains relatively lower than the national average in Sri Lanka. Specifically, rates for diabetes (5.8%) and high blood pressure (5.8%) are at a minimum among private sector employees.

When analyzing non-communicable disease prevalence by employment status, employers defined as those who conduct business or economic activities with hired employees report the highest prevalence rates for diabetes (13.8%) and high cholesterol (11.0%). This represents a significant increase compared to the national average. Among own-account workers (those engaged in their own economic activities), the prevalence of heart disease (3.2%) is higher than in all other employment categories. Similarly, the prevalence of high blood pressure (11%) is also high among this group. Unpaid family workers (those contributing to family economic activities without a wage) report the highest prevalence rates for high blood pressure (13.4%) and asthma (2.5%). The prevalence of high cholesterol (10.7%) is also high within this group. Furthermore, the prevalence rate of kidney disease among own-account workers and unpaid family workers (1.1%) is approximately four times higher than that of government employees (0.3%).